CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

BRAND STRATEGIST IN THE AI ERA

Anyone can generate a logo now. Knowing what a company should stand for is the scarce part.

★ TL;DR — ~$75K median for the thinking layer of marketing, with a ramp of 1–6 months if you bring marketing experience. The catch: strategy is hired on proof and taste — nobody gives the big chair to a beginner with opinions. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

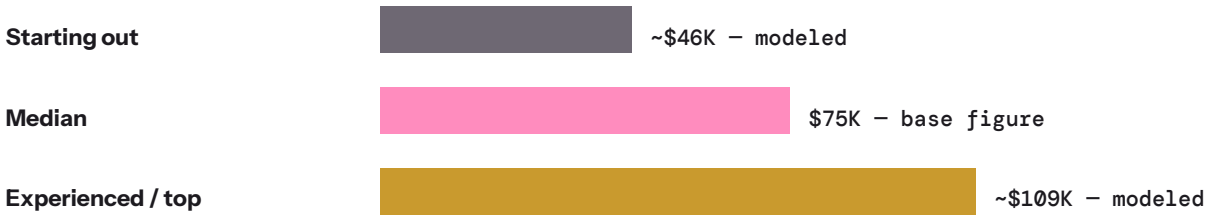
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- Positioning decides whether marketing spend works at all — companies pay for that clarity.
- It's research plus narrative: customers, competitors, and one sharp story.
- AI generates endless options; choosing the right one is the entire job.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Brand Strategist is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A BRAND STRATEGIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Research customers, competitors, and market gaps

- ✓ Define positioning, messaging, and brand voice
- ✓ Brief designers and writers so output stays on-strategy
- ✓ Audit brands and recommend what to fix, keep, or kill

Think: the architect of a company's reputation — others pour the concrete of posts and ads; you drew the plans.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI drafts messaging variants, summarizes research, and generates moodboards and names by the hundred. Raw material is now free.	Taste and courage: picking ONE position and defending it in a room full of stakeholders who all prefer something safer.

⚠ **Strategy without execution scars doesn't sell. Most strategists earn the chair after years of doing marketing, not instead of it.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Fully remote, meeting-and-documents work ✓ Variety: every client is a new puzzle ✓ A clean path to your own consultancy	✗ Your work is judged subjectively, in rooms you don't control ✗ Clients ask for strategy, then buy the cheapest logo anyway ✗ Feast-or-famine pipeline if you consult

Good fit? You see patterns in people and markets, write sharply, and can argue a position without ego.
Bad fit? You want a checklist job, or you fall in love with your first idea.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — AGENCY STRATEGY TEAM	DOOR B — IN-HOUSE / CONSULTANT
Join an agency as a junior strategist or planner. You'll touch many brands, learn research methods on live briefs, and watch senior strategists work rooms.	Take a brand role inside one company, or consult for small businesses if you already have a marketing track record. Depth over variety — you live with your decisions.

Smart move: Publish teardown analyses of real brands' positioning. One sharp public teardown is a better portfolio than ten certificates.
Where you land after: Senior strategist, brand director, or independent positioning consultant.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	BUILD TEARDOWN	GET EXECUTION	RUN A	LEARN TO	SPECIALIZE YOUR

STEP 1 — Learn the frameworks

FREE–$150 · MONTH 1

- Study positioning, segmentation, and messaging hierarchy.
- Learn basic research: interviews, review mining, competitor audits.

STEP 2 — Build teardown reps

FREE · MONTHS 1–2

- Write full strategy teardowns of 4–5 real brands.
- For each: audience, promise, proof, and what's broken.

STEP 3 — Get execution context

PAID · MONTHS 2–4

- Work any marketing role — content, social, email — inside real campaigns.
- Strategy learned without execution is just vocabulary.

STEP 4 — Run a real positioning project

MONTHS 3–5

- Take a small business through interviews to a positioning statement.
- Deliver the document a designer could actually build from.

STEP 5 — Learn to present strategy

WORKING · MONTHS 4–6

- Present your work to a skeptical audience and defend choices.
- The deck is the product demo — make it airtight.

STEP 6 — Specialize your angle

WORKING · MONTH 6

- Pick a lane: startups, local services, personal brands, rebrands.
- Your past projects become the case studies that sell the next one.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: pick one well-known brand and write a one-page positioning teardown.
- □ Days 1–30: frameworks learned; three teardowns written and shared.
- □ Days 31–60: inside a marketing role or project; research skills practiced on live customers.
- □ Days 61–90: one real positioning project delivered to a real business.

 Day 90: you have case studies, not just opinions — the currency this field trades in.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ STAND FOR ONE THING. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.